



This 17th-century ink and watercolor miniature of Shah Jahan shows the fifth Mughal emperor with a holy nimbus around his turbaned head.



A hand-colored woodcut depicting the siege of Magdeburg by the Holy Roman Empire. The city was later burned and 20,000 people massacred.



AFTER MORE THAN A YEAR, THE SIEGE OF LA ROCHELLE,

the strongest Protestant enclave in France, ended in October 1628 with **defeat for the Huguenots**. The siege was Richelieu's response to lingering hopes of Huguenot opposition to the French Crown, and was designed to both crush Huguenot resistance and dismantle its still formidable military. Although Richelieu acknowledged their right to religious toleration, he made sure they could mount **no further threat to the Crown**.

The publication in 1628 of *On the Motion of the Heart and Blood*, by royal physician **William Harvey** (1578–1657), marked one of the major discoveries of the 17th century. It **explained** both the circulation of the blood and the **functioning of the heart**, by using observation and experimentation.

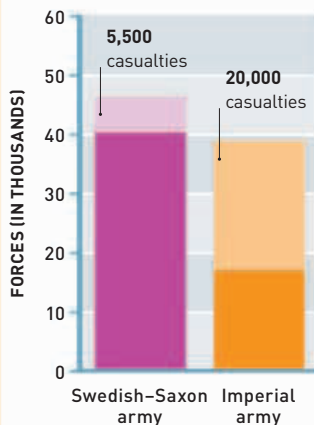
One of the great leaders of India's Mughal Empire, **Shah Jahan** (1592–1666), was **crowned**

Siege of La Rochelle

Chief minister of France, Cardinal Richelieu, inspects the formidable sea wall defenses of La Rochelle, during the siege of 1628.

emperor in 1628. His 30-year reign would be a **golden age for Mughal India**, hugely increasing the size of its territory as well as initiating a great flowering of Mughal architecture and culture.

In the 17th century, rulers across Europe embraced the idea of **strong central authority** as the only guarantee of stability. In England, for Charles I (1600–49), absolute monarchy was legitimized by his conviction that he had been divinely sanctioned by God to rule. In 1629, irritated by its checks on his authority, he **dismissed Parliament**, provoking a **growing resentment** among those seeking to share power at what were seen as attempts to impose illegal taxes.



THE ENTRY OF SWEDEN INTO THE THIRTY YEARS' WAR

in 1630 added a new dimension to the conflict. It was still essentially a religious war—one that the Catholic Holy Roman Emperor Ferdinand II was clearly winning. Exploiting this, Sweden's Lutheran king, **Gustavus Adolphus** (1594–1632), presented himself as the **savior of the Lutheran princes** of north Germany. Yet he was potentially as much a threat to them as to Ferdinand. Having spent the previous 19 years fighting the Russians, Poles, and Danes for control of the Baltic, he now **hoped to dominate its German coast** too. His intervention might

Battle of Breitenfeld

At Breitenfeld in 1631, a strong Swedish-Saxon army inflicted huge numbers of casualties on an army of the Holy Roman Empire.

have led to nothing, however, had not the Imperial troops besieging the Lutheran stronghold of Magdeburg in 1631 then **massacred the population**. This provoked outrage among the Lutheran princes. With their political support, in addition to substantial French funding, Gustavus Adolphus inflicted a **crushing defeat** over an Imperial army at **Breitenfeld**, near Leipzig, in September 1631. At this stage, his army marching triumphantly south, Gustavus Adolphus seems to have conceived a vision of an empire that included both Sweden and Germany. Yet the events of the following year would destroy this hope (see 1632).

On a day in November 1630, forever known as the **Day of Dupes**, the enemies of Cardinal Richelieu attempted to overthrow him. They commanded Louis XIII to replace Richelieu with **Marie de**

copper alloy barrel



Swedish field cannon

This cannon was used by the army of Gustavus Adolphus. The barrel has a caliber (diameter) of 2 3/4 in (7 cm), and weighs 440 lb (200 kg).



Queen of France

Portrait of Marie de Medici, the second wife of King Henry IV of France, who attempted to displace Cardinal Richelieu in 1630.

Medici (1575–1642), the mother of the king, and when he retired to ponder his decision they believed they had been successful. Yet **powerful friends saved Cardinal Richelieu**, and the king's mother was exiled to Compiègne.

900
THE
APPROXIMATE
NUMBER OF
PEOPLE BURNT
AT THE STAKE
AFTER THE
WÜRZBURG
WITCH TRIALS

